to cover different aspects of audit work in a systematic manner within a preset time frame. It enhances the quality of audit work. Audit plans should cover knowledge about client's accounting systems and policies, internal control procedures and coordinating the work to be performed. Plans should be flexible so that they can be developed or revised as and when required by the auditor.

4.1.3 Benefits or Advantages of Audit Planning

An efficient and effective audit plan provides the following benefits:

1. **Accomplishment of Objectives:** Audit plan ensures that it provides right means to accomplish audit objectives. Further it also ensures that appropriate attention is devoted to important areas of audit.
2. **Identification of Problems:** A well drawn and established audit plan helps in identifying potential problems.
3. **Timely Completion of Work:** It ensures that work is completed properly within the specified time and no important area is left out. It also ensures that all important areas of management receive attention.
4. **Facilitates Coordination:** It facilitates coordination of the audit work done by auditors and other experts.
5. **Better Audit Work:** It helps in improving the quality of audit work and provides promptness and perfection in audit performance.

4.1.4 Factors Affecting Audit Planning

The following factors should receive due consideration while planning:

- Size of the company and nature of its operations.
- Accounting system, internal control and adherence to standard.
- Environment in which the company operates.
- Previous experience with the client; and
- Knowledge of client's business.



4.2 Audit Programme

4.2.1 MEANING

An audit programme is a detailed, written statement designed by the auditor indicating the work to be performed by the audit assistants, specifying the time limit for completion of work, instructions and guidance to the audit staff. In short, it is a tool for planning, directing and controlling the audit work.

An audit programme is a detailed plan of the auditing work to be performed. It specifies the procedures to be followed in the conduct of audit more efficiently. The auditor outlines the whole procedure of audit from beginning till the finalization of audit report. Audit programme is generally contained in the audit notebook.

4.2.2 Definition

Prof. Meigs defines an audit programme as, "an audit programme is a detailed plan of the

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